

AALOK DHONJU

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SUMMARY

CCNA-certified IT professional with hands-on experience supporting enterprise networks, systems, and end-users. Adept at navigating ticket-driven environments to troubleshoot and resolve issues across Cisco, VMware, and Zscaler platforms. Equipped with Python and PowerShell scripting skills to automate routine tasks, ready to deliver immediate value in IT roles.

EDUCATION

Northern Kentucky University, Highland Heights, KY August 2022 - May 2026

- *BS in Information Technology (Network & Systems Track) with a minor in Information Security, and completed coursework for the IT Cloud and Systems Track* | [GPA: 3.947](#)
- *Relevant Coursework:* Network Security, Information Security Management, Network Design/ Troubleshooting, Cloud Computing, Scripting I, Database Administration, Advanced Network and System Administration, Internet of Things
- *Awards:* Eva G. Farris Informatics Scholarship (2025), US Bank Cyber Security Scholarship (2025, 2024), Fidelity NKU Hackathon Winner (2024), Haile Enrichment Fund (2022)
- *Organizations:* NKCyber (Red Team Member), Student Government (Student Senator), Baptist Campus Ministry (Member)
- *Cooperative Education Program:* Fall 2025 (academic term completed December 2025)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Chartwells Higher Ed, Digital Systems Support *Intern* Oct 2023 - Aug 2025 | Nov 2025 - Present
Highland Heights, KY

- Administered and worked on migrating NKU Dine-On-Campus to a newer version using proprietary GUI and HTML/CSS stack, tasked with regularly updating events and operational statuses.
- Analyzed data from internal surveys, webpages, Oracle Hospitality, and Mashgin Kiosk using Python, Excel, and Power BI to present them at the manager's meeting periodically.
- Managed over 20 digital displays using Wand Digital, distributed a monthly newsletter for over 300 subscribers using Constant Contact, and scheduled social media content provided to 4 platforms with Sprout Social

Medpace, *Network Engineering Co-op (NKU Fall 25')*, Cincinnati, OH Aug 2025 - Oct 2025

- Supported enterprise network and infrastructure operations across offices, data centers, and IDF/MDF environments.
- Resolved 30+ core infrastructure support tickets per month using ServiceNow workflow, following documented workflows and escalation procedures.
- Assisted with network equipment deployments, upgrades, and troubleshooting during on-site maintenance activities.
- Completed tickets for server builds, tagging, validation, and retirements in VMware vSphere, including Active Directory verification and asset tagging.
- Used PowerShell to automate tasks for auditing Windows Server configurations and generated audit reports for the infrastructure team.

Northern Kentucky University, *Undergraduate Researcher*, Highland Heights, KY May 2024 - April 2025

- Deployed and managed virtualized server environments using VMware vSphere for research and testing purposes.
- Implemented and maintained a MySQL server with automated data handling using APIs in Python Script.
- Assisted in creating and securing data flows between distributed systems using blockchain, hashing, and cryptography.

NKU College of Informatics, *Teaching Assistant*, Highland Heights, KY August 2024 - December 2024

- Led lab sessions, exam reviews on Cisco routing and switching (ROAS, VLANs, OSPF, STP) using enterprise equipment and GNS3 for a class of 20+ students

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Certifications: Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA), ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC), CompTIA Network+ CE, Google Cybersecurity Certificate

Networking: Cisco Routing and Switching, VLANs, OSPF, EIGRP, VRRP, STP, EtherChannel, IPv4/ IPv6, WAN

Security: Firewalls, ACLs, NAT, IPS/ IDS, VPN (IPSec, GRE, SSL), Cisco ASA, Zscaler (ZIA/ ZPA)

Cloud and Virtualization: AWS VPC, EC2, Route 53, VMware vSphere & ESXi, Docker, Proxmox

Automation and Scripting: PowerShell, Python, Ansible, Bash

Monitoring and Tools: SolarWinds, Wireshark, Splunk, NetBox, ServiceNow (SNOW), Active Directory RSAT, Tanium, LAN Sweeper, GitHub, Cisco DNA, Meraki

Operating Systems: Windows Server, Linux, macOS, Cisco IOS

PUBLICATIONS

- S. Poudel, R. Khan, A. Dhonju, N. Miya, "SPHERE: A Secure Provenance-Aware Hierarchical Ecosystem for Reliable Edge Computing Services," IEEE AIIoT 2025, Seattle, WA, USA. DOI: [10.1109/AIIoT65859.2025.11105318](https://doi.org/10.1109/AIIoT65859.2025.11105318)
- G. Baral, A. Dhonju, M. Sah, A. Khanal, S. Shrestha, "Enhancing Emotion Classification with Human-in-the-Loop Verification for Facial Expression Recognition," IEEE AIBThings 2025, Mt Pleasant, MI, USA. DOI: [10.1109/AIBThings66987.2025.11296170](https://doi.org/10.1109/AIBThings66987.2025.11296170)

PROJECTS

Docker & NGINX Reverse Proxy

Dec 2025

- Deployed a multi-service containerized environment on an AWS VPC environment, using a single EC2 instance hosting Docker, and hosted five different web applications using a centralized reverse proxy manager
- Configured NGINX Proxy Manager to route traffic to different Docker containers using subdomains with HTTPS.

Server Cloning & Active Directory Deployment

Nov 2025

- Used FOG Project to capture, deploy Windows Server images, and facilitate IPv4 network booting.
- Installed and configured Active Directory, creating a primary domain controller and a secondary controller for redundancy. Set up organizational units, roles, and user accounts.

Local NAS Server

May 2025

- Configured a Raspberry Pi as a network-attached storage (NAS) server using Samba, enabling access from macOS, Windows, and web browsers.
- Mounted shared directories on client systems and provided web access using Apache2 and Python HTTP server.

CLI Linux Administration Program Using Python

Dec 2024

- A comprehensive system administration tool for Linux using Python to automate various tasks, including user creation/ deletion from CSV, system monitoring (CPU, Memory), and logging.
- Used Python Modules: OS, SUBPROCESS, ARGPARSE, CSV, LOGGING, SMTPLIB, TIME.

GNS3 Lab - Securing Layer 2

Nov 2024

- Protected a Cisco Network against a variety of threats, like: CAM Overflow Attack, DHCP Snooping, ARP Spoofing, and MAC Spoofing.
- Used Port Fast, BPDU Guard, ARP Inspection, and Auto-recovery in Cisco 3850 alongside the creation of access VLANs for unused interfaces